

BRAC University
BRAC Business School
BBA Program
Fall Semester: 2023, Final Examination
Course Code: BUS 201, Course Title: Business & Human Communication
1 Hour 30 minutes
Total marks: 30

ONLY ATTEMPT THIS SEGMENT IF YOU ARE DONE WITH MCQ

Answer any Four(4) questions of the following six(6) questions

Each Question carries 5 Marks.

Your company, M.K. Electronics, has just received a complaint from a customer who recently purchased a Whirlpool washing machine from you. The customer is claiming a complete replacement of the product. In the letter, the customer mentions that the washing machine functioned properly for the first three days of use. However, on the fourth day, the washing machine started giving trouble: the water was not draining out properly and the spin function was faulty. As a follow-up, you sent a technician who reported back with the information that he found a large bunch of keys stuck in the machine's filter. The instruction manual and the warning sticker (on top of the machine) both clearly state that items such as coins or keys (left in the pockets of clothes) can damage the filter, the pump, and the drum.

In your refusal letter of this claim, which approach would you use and why?

Describe what strategies you should employ and what things you should avoid for writing this letter.

Sitting in your Motijheel office at the accounting firm of Khan Associates Ltd., clacking away on your calculator, you wonder whether you could be doing this work from your home. You haven't spoken to any co-workers in more than two hours. If you completed your work in time, would your location matter? As an entry-level accountant, you've participated in location audits at major companies for nearly a year now. If your bosses trust you to work while staying at a hotel, why not let you work from home, where you already have an office with computer, phone, and fax machine? You'd love to regain those two hours you lose commuting to and from work every day. You consider three options for persuading your boss to let you work from home:

Knocking him on Slack to let him know how you feel and attempt to persuade him

Physically going to his office during lunch break (the only time he's available!) and have a quick word.

Write him a detailed email using lots of justifications and reasons in order to persuade him to comply.

Which one will you choose? Explain your choice with justifications. Rank them (1st choice, 2nd choice, 3rd choice) with justifications for each one.

3. Assume you have to prepare a report on social stigmas associated with mental illness in our country, for which you need to conduct both primary and secondary research.

What type of search engine would be most useful for finding your secondary data?

State at least two ways you can evaluate the validity of these sources of information in secondary research.

What are the two most common forms of primary research methods? State 4 different questions you will put in a questionnaire survey that would solicit valid answers to identify people's biases against mental illness.

4. Clinical trial transparency is the only way to monitor the safety and efficacy of vaccines. Transparency International and the University of Toronto reported that many clinical trials lacked transparency. There is a high chance of data manipulation if clinical trials were not transparent and rushed. The research further revealed poor transparency in contracts between governments and drug companies. A few reports were published but almost all had redactions of key information such as the total price paid, price per dose and delivery schedules. There is a huge disparity as a few nations had to pay more. Moreover, these published reports are not publicly accessible. Imagine that the country is in the middle of a pandemic, and you are working as the head researcher at a pharmaceutical giant that will launch its vaccine soon. You are assigned the task of writing a report on the vaccine.

Discuss how you could ensure that the report you develop would be successful.

5. You are to present for a business to business sales call where you are selling a specialized military service on behalf of a German software company that tailor makes security software.

Your audience will have A senior military officer who was trained in Germany. He is from an urban city and plays the violin.

A government official who has been 4 years into the service who joined by passing the BCS exam and comes from a small town. Even though he is in the security department, he has a degree in Bangla Literature.

Japanese Engineers who want to start the project as soon as possible. They work long hours and take pride in their sacrifices for work.

In this situation, for your presentation. You are very unsure if you are the right person to present and you want to have an electronic presentation. Please discuss the advantages and disadvantages of such a format of presentation in this particular situation.

6. Ms. Rahman plans on taking a voluntary 5-year break from her successful career after her childbirth including her maternity leave because of some unavoidable personal family reason. She holds a Bachelor's in Business Administration along with her management level experience. However, she is a bit apprehensive whether employers would consider this break in a positive way once she rejoins the workforce. She also feels her competitiveness will be compromised. You are her friend and also a HR consultant.

a) What advice would you dispense to her so that her competitiveness and demand are not compromised in the job market after 5 years?

b) Deciding on whether she considers your advice or not, which form of resume do you think she should consider? Justify your answer.

Letter Writing: 10 Marks

The Context:

Assume that you are the Occupational Health and Safety Manager (Manager, OHS) at Cemex™ Cement (Bangladesh) Limited. Your company is a cement manufacturing operation with a large capacity cement factory: it has a daily production tonnage of 5000 tons. The cement packaging and handling zone of your factory is a location where 200 workers work 8 hour shifts 24 hours a day. This means 600 employees are exposed to the area daily. Owing to the nature of the product, and production process, this zone – packaging and handling (P & H)-- is full of dust whirls, and the workers are subject to harmful inhalation and ingestion of fine Zinc and other particles (which are essentially production raw materials). The company has issued them with industry grade masks, and protection gear, but the level of dust saturation in dust clouds, and the prolonged exposure, renders the gear permeable by dust. To tackle the situation effectively Cemex Cement management needs to purchase at least eight (8) electric dust collectors for the P & H zone. The dust collectors will improve matters significantly as 80% of the prevailing dust saturation can be reduced, and workers can work in more comfortable protection gear replacing the heavy armor they are using now. This, you believe, will not only improve worker morale, but also reduce allergy related medical absenteeism which is very common to the P & H workers. Aside from reduction of medical bills for which your company must pay, Cemex also stands to avert the risk of heavy fines that may be levied by Bangladesh Government's Department of Inspection for Factories and Establishments (DIFE). Unhealthy OSH, if proved on factory inspection, can escalate production costs owing to payment of fines, and also result in a public relation (PR) issue as the company image will be tarnished.

Your Task:

You will write a persuasive email to Mr. Jose Saenz De Miera, Managing Director, Cemex Cement (Bangladesh) Limited, and persuade him to allocate funds for the purchase of 8 AGICO™ dust collectors. In your letter you should mention that the average medical expense per employee is US \$ 2/month at the P & H zone of the factory, and the investment of US \$ 8,000 for the dust collectors will be paid off in a very short time. The probable amount of fine levied by DIFE can be as high as Taka 2,500,000, and the factory may also be shut down for a while until necessary remedial measures are taken by Cemex Bangladesh. In order to underscore the urgency of the matter urge him to take action within a specified date (a week before a formal factory inspection by DIFE will be carried out). Use the AIDA plan to compose the email, and omit or add details where necessary.